

FIGURE 3.3 Shinkichi Tajiri, *The Berlin Wall, 1969–1970*. (Shinkichi Tajiri Estate)

But through his attention to materiality and the surrounding social scenes, Tajiri comes face-to-face with his exiled American status. His path through the city starts with images at the rural southern edge of West Berlin, as noted, in the city's American section. Soon after, Tajiri brings this area's primary geopolitical landmarks—"American Sector" signs denoting exit and entrance along the borderline by the Wall—into dozens of frames of his study (fig. 3.3). Originally, the signs were placed throughout the middle of Berlin, following the occupation of the city after 1945, by all four occupying powers, the United States, Great Britain, France, and the USSR. They remained littered across the landscape as the border was fortified, even at locations without obvious checkpoints. Among the most recognizable instructions included "You Are Now Leaving the American Sector of Berlin / *Sie Verlassen Den Amerikanischen Sektor*," which would be read while facing east, denoting the end of the allied border zone. From the other side of the sign, which often had to be viewed from the very edge of West Berlin's territory, the text read, "You Are Entering the American sector / Carrying Weapons Off Duty Forbidden / Obey Traffic Rules." Other variations